BOARD OF DIRECTORS · 21 OCTOBER 2026

AI at Wendelkaai: where to start, what it is worth, how to do it safely

Findings of the 12-week discovery and pilot, and one decision.

THE PROBLEM, MEASURED

Skilled people retype documents, and 2 in 100 go wrong

4,000
freight documents keyed by hand every month, by 11 clerks

5.5 min
per document (time study, 60 documents)

2.1%
of documents carry a keying error that costs money later (480 double-checked)

8 months
that two doc desk vacancies have been open, while volume grows 4% a year

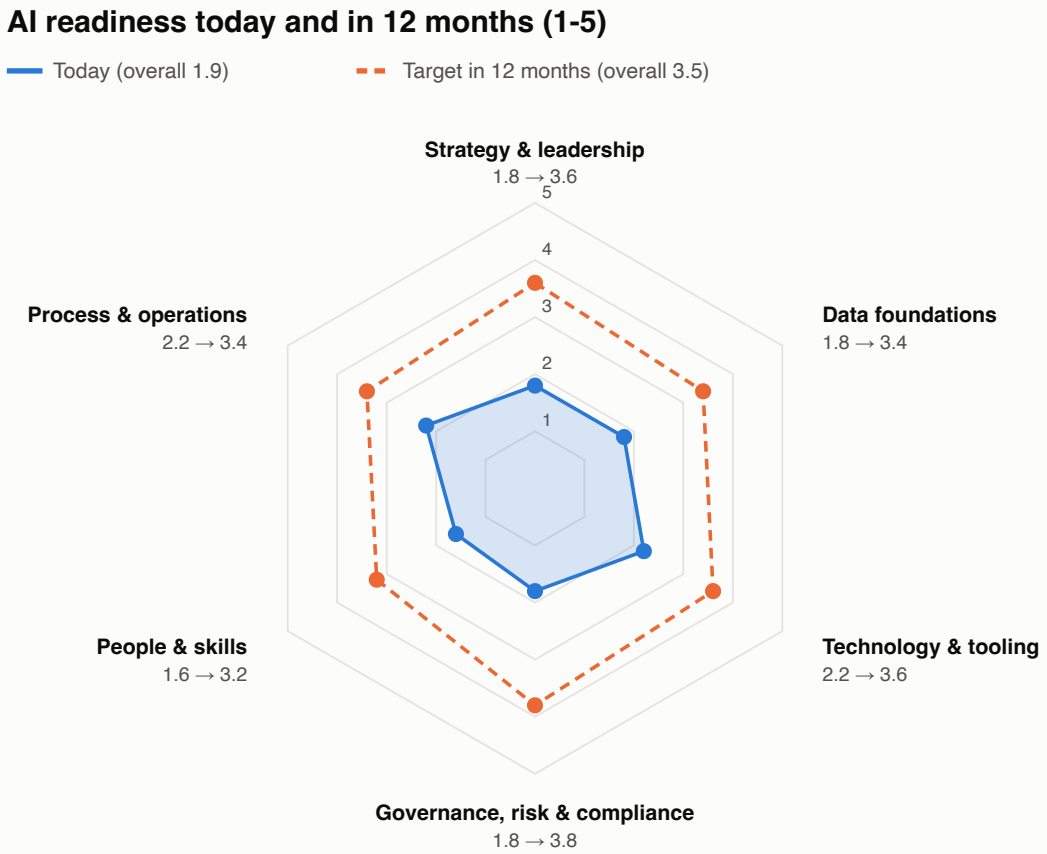
38%
of staff use public chatbots for work; some paste customer data

2
pharma customers asked how we govern AI in their 2026 audits

Source: discovery weeks 1-2 (interviews, time study, mailbox sample, staff survey)

READINESS

Ready to use AI, not yet to govern it: 1.9 of 5

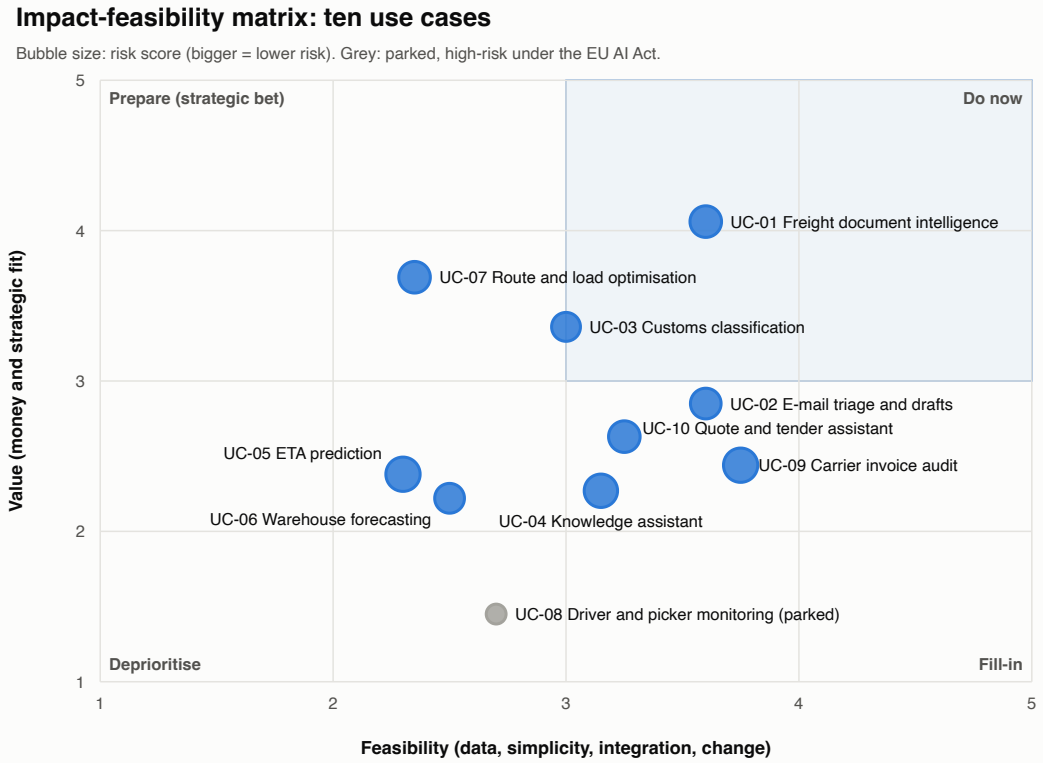


- **Strong enough:** documents are digital, Microsoft 365 and Entra ID in place, ISO/IEC 27001 certified.
- **Missing:** AI policy, AI inventory, an owner for AI, a platform to run it on, labelled data to test it.
- **Lowest:** People & skills (1.6). 61% of staff expect AI to take jobs at the desk.
- **Target in 12 months:** 3.5, paid for by roadmap items, not wishes.

30 items scored on evidence by the consultant and the COO

WHERE TO START

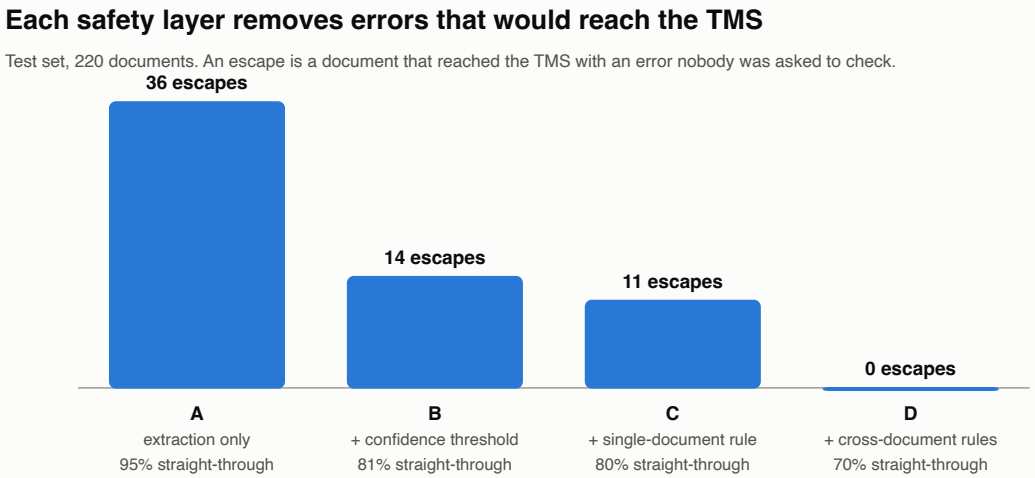
Ten use cases scored; documents come first under every weighting



- **UC-01 Freight document intelligence** ranks first in 100% of 2,000 re-weightings of the criteria.
- **Next:** carrier invoice audit and customer e-mail triage reuse what UC-01 builds.
- **Not generative AI:** route optimisation is a solver, and a buy decision.
- **Parked:** performance scoring of drivers and pickers: high-risk under the EU AI Act, no owner.

Criteria and weights agreed with the leadership team (45 / 35 / 20)

Reading documents is easy; the clerks' checks make it safe



- Extraction alone: 36 of 220 documents into the TMS with an error.
- The clerks' own checks, written as 14 rules, take that to 0.
- Three rules compare documents of one shipment (weights, package counts, containers). They catch what a confident model gets wrong.
- The first version failed its gate; the evaluation found the gap in the linking logic.

Held-out test set, 220 synthetic documents built from the mailbox sample

RESULT AGAINST THE CRITERIA SET BEFORE THE BUILD

Gate passed on the test set: 70.0% straight-through, no unflagged errors

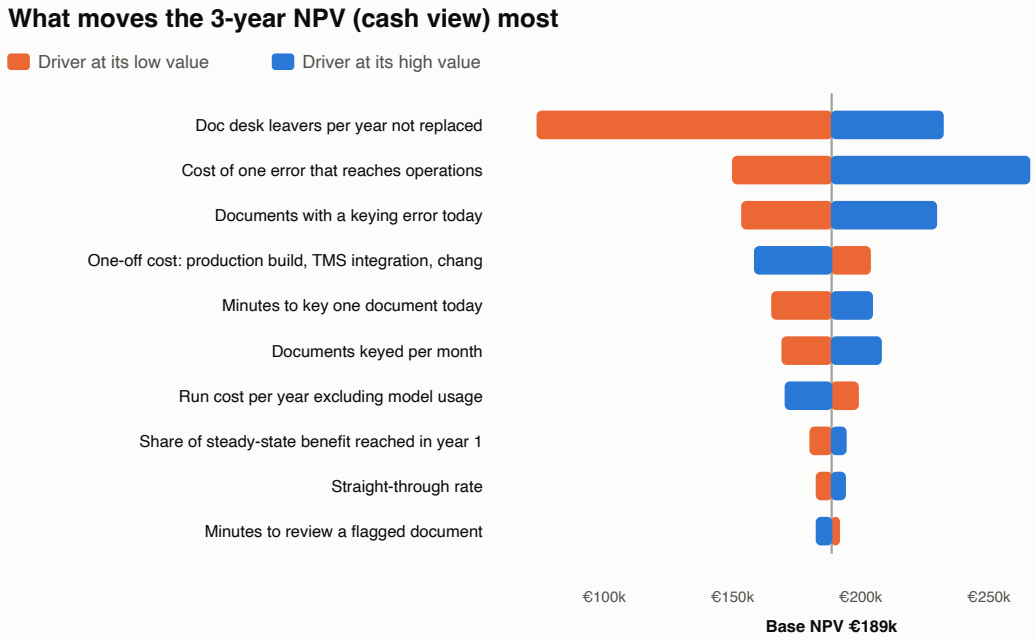
Criterion (workshop 3)	Target	Result
Errors reaching the TMS unseen	≤ 1%	**0.0%**
Below today's human error rate	< 2.1%	**yes**
Straight-through	≥ 50%	**70.0%**
Genuine problems sent to a person	≥ 95%	**100%**
No silent guessing	always	**threshold 0.75**

- **Residual risk:** on the tuning set 2 truck documents with a misread digit slipped through. The production build compares them with the booking.
- **Honest limit:** synthetic documents and an offline stand-in for the model. Go-live depends on the same gate on real documents in shadow mode.

Release gate runs in CI before any change to model, prompt, rule or threshold

WHAT IT IS WORTH

€189k over three years on the cash view; payback 15 months

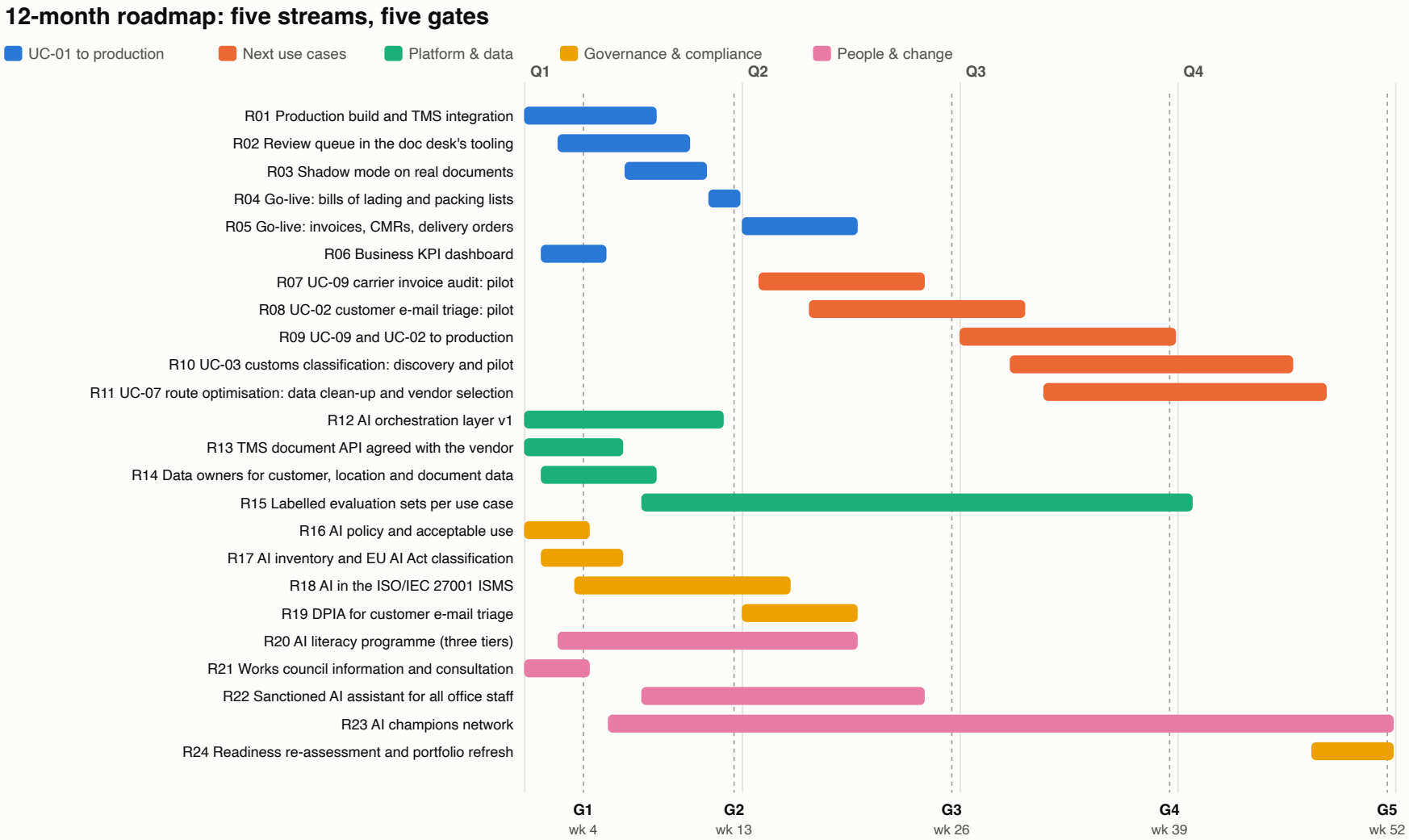


- **One-off €85k, about €20k a year.** Model usage is about €0.020 per document.
- **Cash view:** only hires avoided and leavers not replaced count. Capacity view: €232k.
- **Biggest lever:** whether leavers are replaced, then what an error really costs. Not the model.
- **All leavers replaced?** Still pays back in 22 months.
- **Everything wrong at once:** NPV -€142k. The gates watch those drivers.

8% discount rate; pilot cost (€38k) excluded as sunk

HOW WE GET THERE

Twelve months, five gates; only the first is asked today



G2 week 13: ≥ 60% straight-through and ≤ 1% escapes on real documents, or we stop

Nobody surprised, nothing high-risk, governance before go-live

Commitments to staff

- No redundancies because of AI in this roadmap
- Freed time goes to customs files and exceptions
- Every second leaver not replaced while it scales
- The review queue never evaluates individuals
- Works council informed in week 1, consulted at weeks 14 and 30

Governance in the first 90 days

- One-page AI policy and one sanctioned assistant
- AI inventory, every system classified under the EU AI Act
- AI vendors assessed inside the ISO/IEC 27001 ISMS
- AI literacy for all staff (AI Act Art. 4)
- Human oversight designed in: a person sees every doubt

UC-08 (worker performance scoring) parked: Annex III 4(b) high-risk

THE DECISION

We ask the board for three things

1. Approve UC-01 production and the year-1 foundations: **€85k** one-off, about **€20k** a year, released at gate G2.
2. Endorse the people commitments.
3. Mandate the AI steering group (CEO, CFO, COO, IT manager) to take gates G1-G3 within this envelope.

Wave 2 (carrier invoice audit, customer e-mail triage) comes back in week 26 with its own business case.